Rotaract Club of Xiamen University Malaysia

Rotary Club of Kuala Lumpur Dynamics

Rotary Club of Tun Razak Exchange

SDC Hackathon Participant Handbook



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Welcome to SDC Hackathon. This handbook is prepared to guide all participants throughout the event, including the schedule, rules, submission requirements, judging process, and participant responsibilities.

1. EVENT OVERVIEW

Event Name

SDC: Sustainably Developing Code Hackathon Competition

Organizer

XMUM AI Club

Collaborator

XMUM Rotaract Club

Date

Online Week: October 19th – October 30th, 2026
Physical Hackathon Starts: October 31st, 2026
Pitching Day: November 1st, 2026

Team Size

1–5 members per team

2. OBJECTIVE

2.1. To Bridge the Gap Between Theory and Application:

To provide a structured environment where students can translate academic knowledge into practical, deployed applications through intensive workshops and mentorship.

2.2. To Solve Real-World Challenges via AI:

The event features two to three specific domains focused on developing AI solutions to any problem that aligns with any SDG ranging from 1 - 17.

2.3. To Foster Inter-University & Industry Collaboration:

To connect the top tech talent from major universities with industry mentors and sponsoring companies, creating a "Tech Festival" atmosphere promoting networking and future employment opportunities.

2.4. To Cultivate Student Ingenuity and Complex Problem-Solving:

To empower students to apply their ingenuity, creativity, and problem-solving capabilities to meaningful, real-world challenges. By moving beyond traditional case studies, participants are required to deploy design-thinking methodologies and critical analysis to ensure their solutions are not only technologically viable but also socially or economically impactful.

3. REFERENCE TO TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Participants are required to read and comply with the official Terms and Conditions of the SDC Hackathon. The Terms and Conditions contain important rules and policies related to registration, eligibility, team formation, submissions, judging, plagiarism, disqualification, participant conduct, intellectual property, media consent, and other competition-related matters.

By registering for the SDC Hackathon, participants acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agreed to follow the official Terms and Conditions. In the event of any inconsistency between this Participant Handbook and the official Terms and Conditions, the Terms and Conditions shall take precedence.

4. REFERENCE TO OFFICIAL HANDBOOK

This participant handbook is prepared to provide participants with more detailed guidance on the event flow, schedules, submissions, communication channels, and on-site arrangements. However, all rules, policies, and requirements stated in the Official Handbook remain applicable to all participants throughout the SDC Hackathon.

5. VENUE

This venue will be used exclusively for the final round of the hackathon, including the physical hacking session, finalist preparation, pitching sessions, and related final-stage activities.

Activity	Venue
Briefing Session	A4#G07
Hacking Room	A3#506, A3#508, A3#509, A3#511, A3#517, A3#518
Mentoring/Sleeping Room	Rooms: A3#512 and A3#505
Pitching Room	Room 1: A4#113 Room 2: A5#119
Ceremony	A1-Tan Hua Choon Auditorium
Eating Plan	A3#Ground Floor

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

18 Aug 2026
Open Registration

18 Oct 2026
Close Registration

19 Oct 2026
Participants Orientation / Problem Statement Announcement Day (Online)

19-25 October 2026
Phase 1 (Online): The Preliminary Round

25-28 October 2026
Interim Phase: Judging / Shortlisting

28-30 October 2026
Phase 2 (Online): The Upgrading Round, Top 15 teams per domain refine their solutions

31 October 2026
Final Phase (Physical): 24-Hour Physical Hackathon in XMUM

1 November 2026
Final Phase (Physical): Pitching & Closing Ceremony

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.1. Pre-Event Preparation Requirements

6.1.1. Teams must prepare all required equipment and technical setup before the event, including laptops, chargers, software installations, development tools, accounts, multi-plug adapters, and any backup equipment needed for development or demonstration.

6.1.2. Teams need to create and prepare their GitHub repository after the hacking period begins. Repositories should be set to private during the hacking period to prevent unauthorized copying or access by other teams.

6.1.3. Before the submission deadline, teams must add the committee's designated GitHub account(s) as collaborators to allow the organizing committee and judging panel to access and review the submitted code.

6.1.4. Teams are responsible for ensuring that their GitHub repository link is accessible to the organizing committee and judging panel before the submission deadline. Inaccessible repositories may affect the team's eligibility for judging.

6.1.5. Teams planning to use large pre-trained models, datasets, APIs, cloud services, or external tools must prepare the required access, files, and configurations before the physical event to avoid technical delays during the hacking period.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.1.6. Teams must ensure that no sensitive information, such as API keys, passwords, private credentials, or payment details, is exposed in their GitHub repository.

6.2. Problem Statement Reveal

6.2.1. The official problem statement for the SDC Hackathon will be revealed online on 19 October 2026, 08:00:00 PM MYT (UTC+8).

6.2.2. Participants are required to attend the online announcement and review the challenge details before starting the competition. The session will provide important information regarding the competition theme, problem statement, expectations, and next steps for the preliminary round.

6.2.3. Any changes to the schedule, access link, or related instructions will be updated through the official Discord server.

6.3 Phase 1: Online Preliminary Round

6.3.1. The Online Preliminary Round will be conducted from 19 October 2026, 08:00:00 PM MYT (UTC+8), to 25 October 2026, 7:59:59 AM MYT (UTC+8).

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.3.2. During this phase, registered teams are required to develop their initial solution based on the released problem statement. Teams are expected to work on their idea, prototype, documentation, and preliminary submission materials within the official preliminary round period.

6.3.3. All submitted work must be created by the registered team members. Any external resources, third-party materials, open-source libraries, datasets, templates, APIs, or AI tools used must be properly declared in the team's submission.

6.3.4. Each team must submit the required preliminary deliverables before the stated deadline. Submissions made after the deadline may not be accepted.

6.3.5. Preliminary Round Deliverables:

6.3.5.1. Product Requirement Documentation
This is to be completed using the official Submission Template provided by the organizing committee. This document must clearly outline the problem statement being addressed, its alignment with the assigned SDG(s), the target user/beneficiary group, the scope and boundaries of the proposed solution, and the key features being built. Judges use this to assess problem understanding and real-world impact.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.3.5.2. Pitch Deck Slides

A structured slide deck covering the problem, proposed solution, technical approach, and expected impact. This should align with and support the narrative delivered in the pitching video, the visual backbone of the same pitch.

6.3.5.3. A Live/Functional Prototype Access

This is a deployed link or demo build; teams must provide a working link or accessible build of their solution, not just a video recording or static mockup. This satisfies the "functional user interface" requirement; judges must be able to interact with or directly observe the actual product.

6.3.5.4. Technical & Tools Declaration Document

A declaration listing all major APIs, cloud services, AI tools/LLMs, datasets, models, sponsor-provided resources, and any pre-existing code/materials used in the project. Teams must be prepared to explain and justify any AI-assisted components during judging or verification; undeclared usage may result in point deductions or disqualification.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.3.5.5. GitHub Repository / Source Code Link
Teams must maintain a realistic and continuous Git commit history throughout the hacking period. Repositories that show a complete or near-complete codebase pushed in a single large commit shortly before the deadline may be reviewed by the organizing committee and may result in disqualification if the work is suspected to be pre-built. Before the submission deadline, teams must add the committee's designated GitHub account(s) as collaborators through their repository access settings so the organizing committee and judging panel can review the code.

6.3.5.6. Pitching Video with Prototype Demonstration: 5-7 minutes (YouTube Link)
Teams must complete their pitching video within the allocated time; exceeding the allowed pitching time will result in a deduction of 1 point for every 30 seconds exceeded, subject to the final judging rules.

6.3.2. Once the submission deadline has passed, teams will not be allowed to modify or resubmit their preliminary round materials unless otherwise instructed by the organizing committee.

6.4 Interim Judging and Shorlisting

6.4.1. The interim judging and shortlisting period will take place from 25 October 2026 to 28 October 2026.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.4.2. During this period, the judging panel and organizing committee will review the preliminary round submissions based on the official judging criteria. Shortlisted teams will be selected to proceed to the next phase of the competition.

6.4.3. A maximum of 15 finalist teams per domain will be shortlisted for the next round, subject to the number of domains and final confirmation by the organizing committee.

6.4.4. The confirmation period shall commence upon the official announcement of finalists on 28 October 2026, 8:00:00 PM MYT (UTC+8), and shall close on 29 October, 12:00 PM MYT (UTC+8).

6.4.5. Failure to submit the required forms and confirmation within the stipulated period shall be deemed as withdrawal from the Grand Final.

6.4.6. In the event that a finalist team notifies the Organiser before 29 October, 12:00 PM MYT (UTC+8) that they are unable to participate, the vacant finalist position shall be offered to the next highest-ranked team (e.g., the 16th-ranked team).

6.4.7. The replacement team shall have until 29 October, 08:00 PM MYT (UTC+8), to complete the required forms and confirmation.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.5 Phase 2: Online Upgrading Round

6.5.1. The Online Upgrading Round will be conducted from 28 October 2026 to 30 October 2026.

6.5.2. This phase is only open to shortlisted finalist teams. During this period, finalist teams may continue refining their solutions, improving their prototypes, preparing their final documentation, and developing their final presentation materials before the physical hackathon.

6.5.3. Teams are expected to use this phase to strengthen their solution based on the competition requirements, judging criteria, and any guidance provided by mentors or the organizing committee.

6.6 Final Round: Physical Hackathon

6.6.1. The Physical Hackathon will be held on 31 October 2026, 09:30:00 AM MYT (UTC+8) at Xiamen University Malaysia.

6.6.2. This phase is only open to finalist teams. Finalist teams are required to attend the physical hackathon according to the attendance requirements set by the organizing committee. The physical hackathon will include final development, mentorship, preparation, and submission activities.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.6.3. The final sprint and deliverable submission period will continue until 1 November 2026, 07:59:59 AM MYT (UTC+8). Teams must ensure that all final materials are submitted before the deadline.

6.6.4 Final Round Deliverables:

6.6.4.1. Updated Product Requirement Documentation

A revised version of the original PRD reflecting any refinements made during the Phase 2 Upgrading Round (28–30 October 2026). Should highlight what changed since the preliminary submission and why, based on judge/mentor feedback.

6.6.4.2. Updated Technical & Tools Declaration Document

A document refreshed to reflect any additional APIs, cloud services, AI tools, datasets, or sponsor-provided resources incorporated during the upgrading and final phases. Any new AI-assisted components must be explainable.

6.6.4.3. Final Solution Report

A concise summary of the finished product: core features, technical architecture, SDG impact, and a short account of how the solution evolved from preliminary submission to final build. This gives judges a written reference alongside the live pitch.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.6.4.4. Backup Recorded Pitch Video (YouTube Link)

A pre-recorded demonstration video kept on standby in case of live technical failure (Wi-Fi outage, deployment crash, or AV issues) during the Pitching Day live session on 1 November 2026. Not used unless the live demo cannot proceed.

6.6.4.5. GitHub Repository / Source Code Link

Teams must maintain a realistic and continuous Git commit history throughout the hacking period. Repositories that show a complete or near-complete codebase pushed in a single large commit shortly before the deadline may be reviewed by the organizing committee and will result in disqualification if the work is suspected to be pre-built. Before the submission deadline, teams must add the committee's designated GitHub account(s) as collaborators through their repository access settings so the organizing committee and judging panel can review the code.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.6.4.6. Final Presentation Slides (.pptx)

A structured slide deck covering the problem, proposed solution, technical implementation, SDG relevance, impact, feasibility, and prototype demonstration. This should align with and support the narrative delivered in the live pitching session, the visual backbone of the same pitch. The slides must be able to open and display properly before the assigned pitching slot.

6.6.4.7. Prototype Demonstration / Live Demo Materials

A working prototype link or accessible build of the final solution, together with any files, accounts, or test credentials needed to run the live demonstration during the pitching session. The prototype must be functional and ready for judges to interact with or directly observe.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.6.5. Late submissions after the final deadline may not be accepted. The organizing committee will not be responsible for inaccessible links, incomplete files, incorrect submissions, or technical issues caused by the team's own preparation.

6.6.6. Official Submission Platform: sdchack.my

6.6.7. Teams planning to use large pre-trained models, datasets, or other heavy resources must download and prepare them before arriving at the venue; heavy automated data scraping, mass downloads, or multi-gigabyte downloads during the physical event are not permitted to prevent disruption to the campus Wi-Fi network.

6.6.8. The organizing committee and Xiamen University Malaysia shall not be held liable for any personal belongings or equipment, including laptops, phones, chargers, accessories, or valuables, that are lost, stolen, or damaged during the event; all participants and teams are fully responsible for the safekeeping of their own items.

6.6.9. Participants driving to Xiamen University Malaysia may enter the campus through either the Southern Gate or Eastern Gate, subject to the university's security procedures.

6.6.10. Parking will be available at the A Block basement parking area, specifically around the A3 Building.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.6.11. Participants including the replacement teams who intend to drive must register their vehicle with the organizing committee latest by 29 October 2026, 12:00:00 PM MYT. A temporary visitor pass will be issued for approved registered vehicles.

6.7 Pitching Session

6.7.1 The final pitching session will be held on 1 November 2026, For the time schedule please refer to 7.2.

6.7.2 Each finalist team will present their final solution to the judging panel according to the assigned pitching schedule. Teams are expected to clearly explain their problem, proposed solution, technical implementation, SDG relevance, impact, feasibility, and prototype demonstration.

6.7.3. Pitching Duration: 10 minutes

Q&A Duration: 5 minutes
Pitching Venue: A4#113 and A5#119

6.7.4. Teams must be ready before their assigned pitching slot and complete their presentation within the allocated time; exceeding the allowed presentation time will result in a deduction of 1 point for every 30 seconds exceeded, subject to the final judging rules.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.7.5. Final presentation slides must be submitted in .pptx format. Teams are responsible for ensuring that their slides can be opened and displayed properly before their assigned pitching slot.

6.7.6. Teams are required to use their own laptop for the pitching session and live prototype demonstration. Each team must ensure that their device is compatible with HDMI output or bring the necessary adapter, such as USB-C to HDMI, if required.

6.7.7. The organizing committee will not be responsible for presentation delays, display issues, or demo failures caused by missing adapters, unsupported devices, unprepared files, or technical setup problems from the team's side.

6.7.8. Teams are fully responsible for preparing and bringing all required equipment and technical setup, including laptops, chargers, software installations, multi-plug adapters, backup equipment, and necessary accounts; the organizing committee will not be responsible if a team is unable to develop, run, or present their demo due to missing, unprepared, or malfunctioning equipment or software.

6.7.9. The closing ceremony will be held on 1st November, 2026.

6. COMPETITION TIMELINE

6.8 Judging and Results

6.8.1. All submissions and presentations will be evaluated based on the official judging criteria prepared for the SDC Hackathon.

6.8.2. The judging panel's decision is final. Individual requests to review scores, rankings, or judging decisions will not be entertained unless there is a verified administrative or technical error identified by the organizing committee.

6.8.3. In the event of a tie in the final score, the team with the higher sub-score will be ranked higher based on the following priority order: Technical Execution, Problem-Solution Fit, Impact & Feasibility, Innovation & Creativity, Presentation & Pitch, and Design & UX. If the tie remains after applying all sub-score priorities, the judging panel will make the final decision through unanimous discussion.

6.8.4. The organizing committee reserves the right to update competition procedures, submission requirements, or judging arrangements when necessary. Any official changes will be announced through the official Discord server.

7. EVENT RUNDOWN

7.1 Preliminary Phase Rundown

Date and Time	Activity	Venue
18 Oct 2026	Registration closes	All members must join the official Discord server.
19 Oct 2026, 8:00 PM	Orientation and Problem Statement Reveal (Online)	Reveal the competition theme, problem statement, expectations, and next steps for the preliminary round.
19 Oct, 8:00 PM to 25 Oct, 7:59:59 AM	**Phase 1: Online Preliminary Round**	Teams build their initial solution alongside scheduled mentoring rotations.
By 25 Oct, 7:59:59 AM	Phase 1 Submission Deadline	Submit 6 items: 1. Product Requirement Documentation (official template) 2. Pitch Deck Slides 3. Live/Functional Prototype link 4. Technical & Tools Declaration 5. GitHub Repository link 6. 5-7 minute Pitching Video (YouTube)
25 Oct to 28 Oct 2026	Interim Judging and Shortlisting	Judges review all submissions. Up to 15 finalist teams per domain are shortlisted.
28 Oct 2026, 8:00 PM	Finalists Announced	Shortlisted teams receive the confirmation forms.

7. EVENT RUNDOWN

Date and Time	Activity	Venue
28 Oct, 8:00 PM to 29 Oct, 12:00 PM	Finalist Confirmation Period	Finalists submit the required forms and confirm. Teams that cannot join must notify before 12:00 PM.
28 Oct to 30 Oct 2026	**Phase 2: Online Upgrading Round**	Finalists improve their prototype, update their documents, and prepare their final slides with mentor feedback

7. EVENT RUNDOWN

7.2 Final Phase Rundown

31st October 2026 (Saturday)

08.00 - 09.30 Registration & Refreshments
Finalists and committee arrival. Distribution of welcome packs.

09.30 - 10.30 Opening Ceremony & Briefing
Official welcome, logistical briefing (hacking zones, resting areas) and hackathon commencement.

10:30 – 12:30 Hacking Phase Commences
Teams deploy to their respective hacking rooms to begin ideation and development.

12.30 - 13.30 Lunch & Prayer Break

13.30 - 18.30 Hacking & Mentorship Sessions
Intensive hacking period alongside scheduled mentoring rotations.

18.30 - 19.30 Dinner & Prayer Break

19.30 - 00.00 Evening Hacking Session
Teams continue development into the night.

7. EVENT RUNDOWN

1st November 2026 (Sunday)

08.00 - 09.40 Breakfast &Pitch Preparation
Morning refreshments and pitch preparation (A3 6th Floor)

09:40 – 12:40 Parallel Track Pitching (Part 1)
Teams present their solutions in parallel domain tracks.

12:40 – 13:40 Lunch & Prayer Break

13.40 - 15.40 Parallel Track Pitching (Part 2)
Conclusion of final pitches across all domains.

15.40 - 16.00 Intermission & Score Tabulation
Participants migrate to the Main Auditorium while the committee finalises results.

16.00 - 18.30 Closing Ceremony

8. PHYSICAL HELP DESK

8.1. In addition to the official Discord server, a physical help desk will be available at A3#5th Floor during the physical event for teams to receive critical updates, ask urgent questions, or seek assistance directly from the organizing committee if they experience connectivity issues or are unable to access Discord. The more specific help desk location will be confirmed and announced through the official Discord server before the final day.

9. OFFICIAL TOOLS AND RESOURCES

9.1 Resources Provided

9.1.1. Replit: Each participant receives Replit Core (worth US$20).

9.1.2. RunPod: Each team receives US$25 of RunPod credit for the Preliminary Round.

9.2 Each of the resources shall be provided to participants over the official website within 24 hours before the Preliminary Round, i.e., the team lead shall have access to the resources for all team members through their official portal.

9.3 Teams must use Replit as part of their solution. Teams may also use any other tools, frameworks, or services, as long as Replit is included in the project.

9.4 Teams must use RunPod for any work that needs a GPU. This includes: training a model, fine-tuning a model, and running a model (inference) that needs a GPU. Teams may also use any other tools, frameworks, or services for work that does not need a GPU.

10. SUBMISSION GUIDELINE

10.1. All teams must submit their work through the official SDC Hackathon website: sdchack.my

10.2. Each team is required to submit a valid GitHub repository link through the official website. The repository must include an Apache License 2.0 (LICENSE) file and preserve any applicable copyright in accordance with the Apache License 2.0.

10.3. The submitted GitHub repository must be set to public and must remain accessible to the organizing committee and judging panel throughout the judging period.

10.4. Teams are responsible for ensuring that their GitHub repository is complete, properly organized, and accessible before the submission deadline.

10.5. Inaccessible, private, incomplete, or incorrect repository links may affect the team's eligibility for judging.

10.6. Before submitting, each team must show proof that Replit was used in the project in the Technical and Tools Declaration Document. Teams must give any one of the following as proof: a live deployment Replit URL, a Replit project link for access to the project history, or Replit credit finished. The proof must show the team's own account and project.

10.7. Teams that used RunPod must include a screenshot of their RunPod dashboard in the Technical & Tools Declaration Document. The screenshot must show: Pod ID, GPU type, and the runtime. If the team used RunPod Serverless, show the endpoint URL instead of the Pod ID. The screenshot must show the team's own account.

10. SUBMISSION GUIDELINE

10.8. Before participants submit the preliminary documentation through the website, they can refer to the drive below with folders designed with all official documents that need to be filled & submitted, along with video tutorials on what is needed.

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1xw7c2aN8N-at8hPEULzkcU76e_FFb0Ef

11. MENTORSHIP GUIDELINE

11.1 Mentorship Availability

11.1.1. Mentorship support will be provided during both the preliminary round and final round of the SDC Hackathon to guide teams in improving their solutions, technical implementation, and final presentation.

11.1.2. Online mentorship will be available during the Phase 1 Online Preliminary Round, 19–25 October 2026.

11.1.3. Physical mentorship will be available during the final phase physical hackathon, 31 October 2026, at Xiamen University Malaysia.

11.2 Mentor Slot Booking

11.2.1. Mentor slots will be arranged on a first-come, first-served (FCFS) basis. This is subject to mentor availability.

11.2.2. Teams must request or book mentorship through the official process announced by the organizing committee through the SDC Website.

11.2.3. Teams are encouraged to prepare specific questions before meeting mentors to make the session more effective.

11. MENTORSHIP GUIDELINE

11.3 What Mentors Can Help With

11.3.1. Mentors may provide feedback on the team's problem understanding, solution direction, and overall project feasibility.

11.3.2. Mentors may guide teams on technical approach, AI integration, system design, deployment direction, and debugging strategy.

11.3.3. Mentors may give advice on pitch structure, prototype demonstration, user experience, impact explanation, and SDG alignment.

11.3.4. Mentors may help teams identify weaknesses in their project and suggest areas for improvement.

11. MENTORSHIP GUIDELINE

11.4 What Mentor Cannot Do

11.4.1. Mentors are not allowed to directly build, code, design, write documentation, or complete any part of the project for a team.

11.4.2. Mentors are not allowed to make final project decisions on behalf of a team.

11.4.3. Mentors are not allowed to give unfair advantages, confidential judging information, or private instructions that are not available to other teams.

11.4.4. Mentors are not responsible for ensuring that a team's project works, is submitted correctly, or meets the judging requirements.

12. SPONSOR RECOGNITION AND COLLABORATING PARTNER STATUS

12.1. SDC Hackathon 2026 is delivered in collaboration with our Official Title Sponsor.

12.2. By registering for and taking part in the Event, you agree that the Title Sponsor may describe you, and your team, as a collaborating partner of the Title Sponsor in its marketing, website, investor and promotional materials, by reference to your participation in the Event.

12.3. This recognition refers to your participation in the event only. It does not mean, and the Title Sponsor may not state or imply, that you are employed or engaged by the Title Sponsor, that you endorse it, or that you have any commercial relationship with it beyond taking part in the Event.

12.4. Your participation, judging, scoring, advancement and prize eligibility do not depend on this section in any way, and are not affected if you ask to be excluded.

12.5. You may ask to be excluded at any time, before or after the Event, by writing to xmumai@gmail.com. We will notify the Title Sponsor, which will stop further use within a reasonable period. Neither we nor the Title Sponsor is required to recall materials already printed or distributed, or to remove historical social media content.

13. Aiversecity Orion AI Youth Leaders: Sponsor Community

13.1. When you register, we will share your full name, email address, mobile contact number, and academic institution with Aiversecity, our Official Title Sponsor, and you will be automatically enrolled as a member of the ORION AI Youth Leaders programme, an AI community and talent network operated by Aiversecity, unless you tell us you would rather not be.

13.2. You can decline at registration, or at any time afterwards by writing to xmumai@gmail.com.

13.3. As a member, you may receive access to benefits made available at Aiversecity's discretion, which may include career and internship matching with companies in Aiversecity's business network, AI-related workshops and masterclasses, periodic industry digests, community events, and a digital credential. The availability, content, and continuation of these benefits are determined solely by Aiversecity and are not guaranteed by the Organiser.

13..4 Aiversecity operates the ORION AI Youth Leaders programme and handles your details under its own terms and privacy policy, not ours. Your CV and other registration details are covered separately under your data section. We will publish further programme details here once Aiversecity provides them.

13.5. Your participation, judging, scoring, and prize eligibility in SDC Hackathon 2026 are not affected by whether you join or decline the ORION AI Youth Leaders programme.

13. Aiversecity Orion AI Youth Leaders: Sponsor Community

13.6 ORION AI Youth Community Membership Benefits

- **Monthly AI Insights Briefing.** A curated digest of the latest developments in AI and technology, delivered to members ahead of general release.
- **Build Space Access.** Priority access to co-working and project spaces, together with shared resources such as cloud credits, development tools and mentor office hours.
- **Mentor Matching.** Structured one-on-one sessions with industry professionals and founders, providing guidance on projects, careers and ventures.
- **Members-Only Events.** Priority registration and discounted or complimentary entry to talks, workshops, hackathons and cross-community meetups.
- **Partner Offers and Resources.** Preferential rates on software, courses, certifications and technology events through ORION's partner network.
- **Employer Showcase.** Opportunities to present projects and skills directly to hiring companies, creating pathways to internships, employment and collaboration.
- **Investor Pitching Opportunities.** Opportunities to pitch projects to prospective investors at ORION showcase sessions, with selected work featured to ORION's partners.

14. MISCONDUCT REPORTING PROCESS

14.1. Participants who experience or witness harassment, intellectual property theft, cheating, misconduct, or any violation of the event rules should report the incident immediately.

14.2. Reports may be made directly to a committee member on-site or submitted privately through a Discord ticket in the dedicated reporting channel.

14.3. Participants should provide relevant evidence where possible, such as screenshots, messages, photos, videos, repository links, timestamps, witness details, or any other supporting information related to the incident.

14.4. All reports will be handled confidentially by the organizing committee and reviewed according to the event rules and Terms and Conditions.

15. FAQs

15.1 Can we change team members after registration?

No. Team member changes are not allowed after registration has been completed, nor after the event has officially started.

15.2 Is joining the Discord server compulsory?

Yes. All team members are required to join the official Discord server because important announcements, updates, schedule changes, and instructions will be shared there.

15.3 What happens if I miss an announcement on Discord?

Participants are responsible for checking Discord regularly. Failure to read official announcements will not be accepted as a valid reason for missing deadlines, instructions, or required activities.

15.4 Where can we ask formal questions?

Participants may contact the organizing committee through the official discord server for formal inquiries.
Official Discord Server: https://discord.gg/p72amSbw7X

15.5 When will the problem statement be revealed?

The official problem statement will be revealed online on 19 October 2026, 08:00:00 PM MYT (UTC+8).

15. FAQs

15.6 Where will the problem statement reveal be held?

The problem statement will be conducted online. The access link and related instructions will be shared through the official Discord server.

15.7 Are participants required to attend the problem statement reveal?

Yes. Participants are required to attend the online announcement and review the challenge details before starting the competition.

15.8 How many teams will be shortlisted for the final phase?

Up to 15 teams per domain are expected to be shortlisted for the final phase, subject to confirmation by the organizing committee.

15.9 Can we change our submission after submitting?

Submission changes after the deadline will not be accepted unless otherwise announced by the organizing committee.

15.10 What happens if we submit late?

Late submissions may not be accepted and may affect the team's eligibility for judging.

15. FAQs

15.11 What should we do if our submission link is not working?

Teams are responsible for ensuring that all links, files, repositories, and submitted materials are accessible before the deadline. The organizing committee may not be responsible for issues caused by incorrect, broken, or inaccessible submissions.

15.12 What should participants bring for the physical final phase?

Participants should bring their own:

- Laptop and any necessary devices,
- Charger,
- Extension chord,
- Sleeping bag or blanket,
- Jacket,
- Toiletries including towels,
- Clothes,
- Personal items,
- and any tools required for development and presentation.

15.13 Are participants responsible for their own belongings?

Yes. Participants are responsible for keeping their personal belongings, devices, and valuables safe at all times.

15. FAQs

15.14 Will Wi-Fi be provided?

Wi-Fi access is expected to be provided during the physical final phase. Participants should also ensure that their own devices are ready before the event.

15.15 Will accommodation or resting areas be provided during the physical phase?

Yes. Resting areas will be provided during the physical phase of the hackathon. Participants may use the assigned resting areas according to the instructions given by the organizing committee. However, participants are responsible for bringing their own personal items, such as sleeping bags, jackets, toiletries, extension plugs, chargers, and any other items they may need during the event. These personal items will not be provided by the organizing committee.

15.16 Will shower facilities be available?

Yes. Shower facilities will be available for participants during the physical phase. Participants are advised to bring their own toiletries, towel, change of clothes, and other personal hygiene items.

15. FAQs

15.17 Will transportation be provided?

No. Transportation will not be provided. Participants are responsible for arranging and covering their own travel to and from Xiamen University Malaysia. The organizing committee may provide general directions or venue guidance to help participants locate the event areas on campus.

15.18 Is there a dress code for the event?

Participants are encouraged to wear comfortable and appropriate attire during the hacking sessions. For the pitching session and closing ceremony, participants are advised to wear smart casual or formal attire to maintain a professional presentation standard.

15.19 Will mentors be available to guide participants?

Yes. Mentors will be available during selected sessions to provide guidance, feedback, and advice to participants. Mentors may assist teams by giving suggestions on problem understanding, solution direction, technical development, presentation preparation, and overall project improvement. However, mentors are not allowed to directly build, code, design, or complete the project on behalf of any team.

15. FAQs

15.20 Will datasets be provided?

No fixed dataset will be provided unless otherwise stated in the official domain or problem statement guidelines. Participants may use suitable public datasets, self-collected data, open-source resources, or other permitted data sources, as long as they comply with the competition rules and properly acknowledge the source where required. Participants are advised to refer to the official domain-specific folder or guideline for the latest updates regarding dataset requirements, restrictions, or recommended resources.

15.21 Is there any specific programming language required?

No specific programming language is required. Participants may use any programming language, framework, library, or development tool that they are comfortable with, as long as it is suitable for building their proposed solution. However, the project must still use Replit (see Section 9.3). Any work that needs a GPU must also be done on RunPod (see Section 9.4).

Participants are encouraged to use technologies that help them develop a functional and presentable prototype or minimum viable product. Teams should also be prepared to explain their technical choices, implementation process, and how their solution works during submission or pitching.